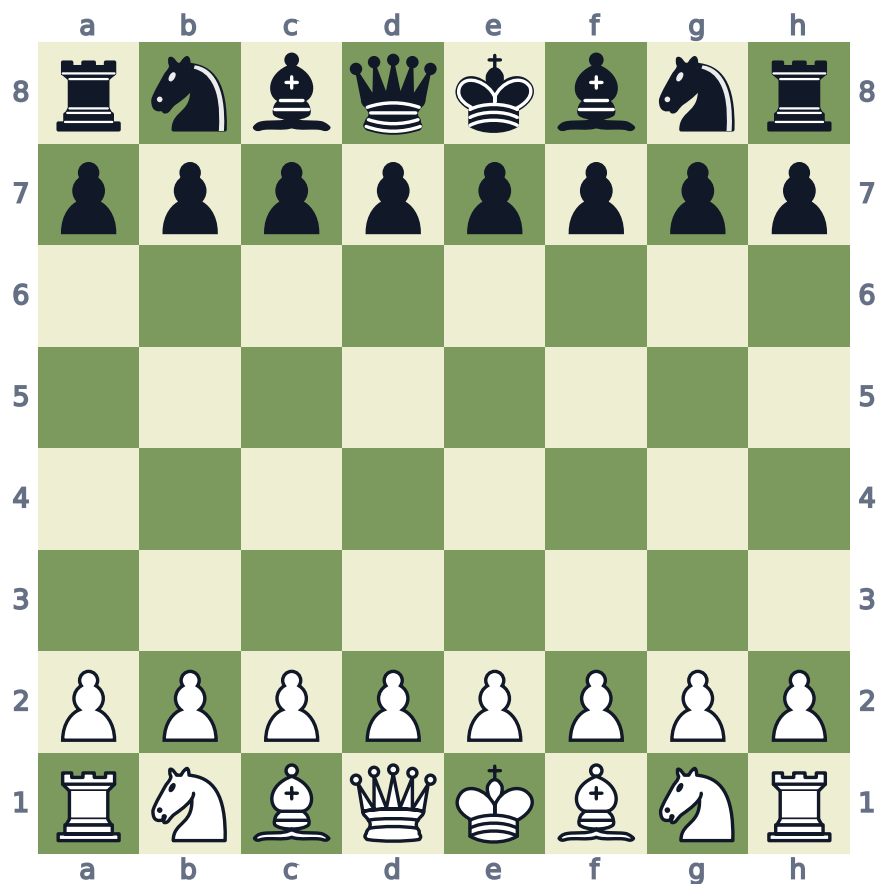


Attacking Chess

Build, calculate, and convert a justified attack



Learn when an attack is justified, how to bring pieces into the king zone, how to remove defenders, and when to convert pressure into a safer gain.

25 learning units | explanations | board laboratories | review system

ORIENTATION

What this course will change

COURSE PROMISE

Learn when an attack is justified, how to bring pieces into the king zone, how to remove defenders, and when to convert pressure into a safer gain.

YOU WILL LEARN TO

- Count real attacking force
- Open lines without exposing your own king
- Build mating nets and use sacrifices responsibly
- Convert a fading attack into another advantage

HOW TO USE THE COURSE

- Study one learning unit at a time. Say the rule in your own words before continuing.
- At each diagram, hide the model answer. Write candidates and the opponent's best reply.
- Use the rule during a slow game, then record whether it actually changed a decision.
- Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Retrieval matters more than rereading.

SCOPE

This course contains 25 integrated learning units. Principles guide attention, but tactics and exact calculation always decide the move.

CORE METHOD

The decision protocol

USE THIS EVERY TIME

A reliable process is more valuable than a brilliant idea used occasionally. Practice the sequence until it becomes automatic under clock pressure.

1**Count effective attackers and defenders.****2****Map entry routes and escape squares.****3****Find the defender holding the position together.****4****Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.****5****Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.****STOPPING RULE**

Choose when one candidate is sufficiently verified for the clock situation. Before moving, inspect the position once from the opponent's perspective.

COURSE MAP

Learning units

- 01 Bring More Pieces Than the Defender
- 02 Open Lines Toward the King
- 03 Opposite-Side Castling Makes Time Critical
- 04 Exchange the Strongest Defender
- 05 Fix a Weakness Before Attacking It
- 06 Create a Second Weakness
- 07 Launch a Pawn Storm Only With Central Security
- 08 Demand Concrete Compensation for a Sacrifice
- 09 Keep Queens When the King Is the Main Target
- 10 Use Threats to Gain Tempi
- 11 Challenge the Base of a Fianchetto
- 12 Exchange Sacrifices Need Positional Returns
- 13 Use an Open Rook-Pawn File Against the King
- 14 Control Flight Squares Before Checking
- 15 Bring the Worst Attacker Into the Attack
- 16 Offer a Queen Trade to Break the Attack
- 17 Blockade the Pawn Storm
- 18 Counter-Sacrifice to Remove the Initiative
- 19 Perpetual Check Is an Active Defensive Resource
- 20 Defend the Entry Square, Not Every Attacked Pawn

COURSE MAP

Learning units

- 21 Build the Mating Net Before Checking
- 22 Open Lines with a Pawn Sacrifice
- 23 Refute Your Own Sacrifice
- 24 Search for Quiet Tactical Moves
- 25 Align a Battery with a Future Target

LEARNING UNIT 01

Bring More Pieces Than the Defender

THE RULE

Build local superiority around the target before sacrificing or opening lines.

WHY IT WORKS

Attacks succeed when more effective force reaches the zone than the defense can organize. An unused rook or bishop is often the missing attacker.

RECOGNITION CUES

Enemy king has limited defenders; pieces can transfer with tempo; lines can be opened.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Raw piece count ignores quality and forcing moves. One powerful defender can neutralize several poorly placed attackers.

BOARD LABORATORY 01

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 a6 5. Bd3 Qc7

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Bring More Pieces Than the Defender'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Attacks succeed when more effective force reaches the zone than the defense can organize. An unused rook or bishop is often the missing attacker. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Before solving ten attacking positions, count useful attackers and defenders in the king zone.

LEARNING UNIT 02

Open Lines Toward the King

THE RULE

Use pawn breaks, exchanges, or sacrifices to create files and diagonals leading to the enemy king.

WHY IT WORKS

Pieces cannot attack through closed pawns. Opening a line converts space and coordination into direct forcing power.

RECOGNITION CUES

Pieces point at the king but pawns block access; a lever can force a capture; king shelter has a fixed pawn.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

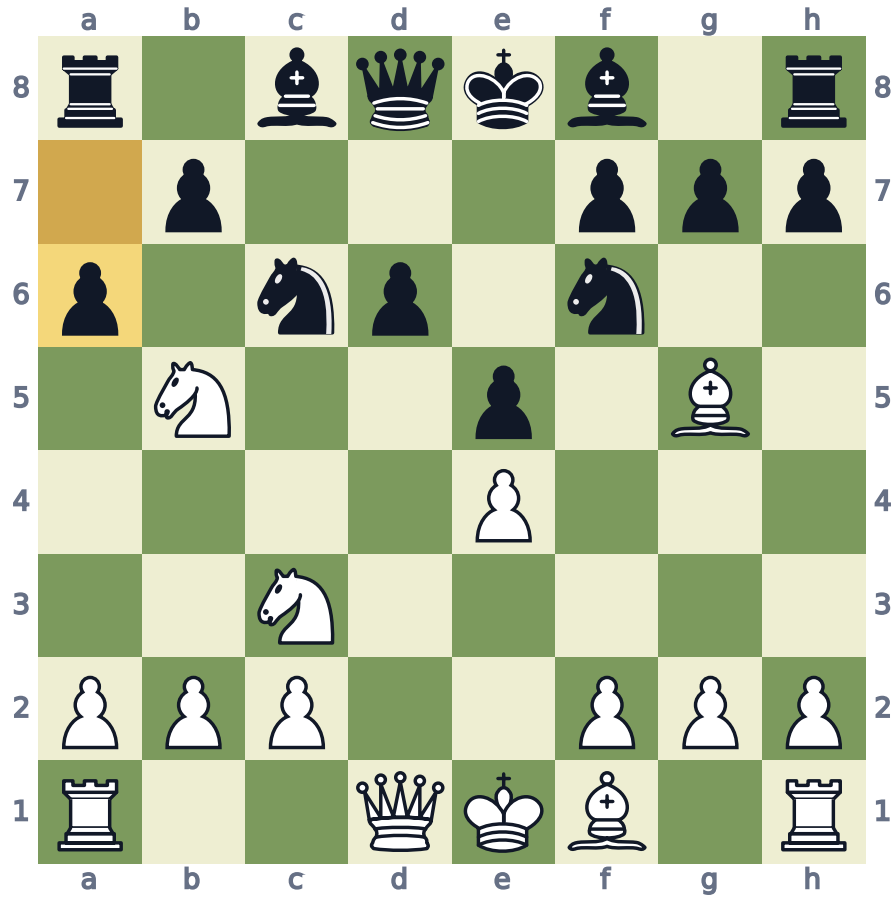
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Opening a line can expose your own king or activate defensive rooks. Calculate both directions.

BOARD LABORATORY 02

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



5. Nc3 e5 6. Ndb5 d6 7. Bg5 a6

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Open Lines Toward the King'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Pieces cannot attack through closed pawns. Opening a line converts space and coordination into direct forcing power. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

For five attacking positions, identify the exact pawn exchange that opens the most valuable line.

LEARNING UNIT 03

Opposite-Side Castling Makes Time Critical

THE RULE

When kings castle on opposite wings, prioritize direct pawn storms and forcing play over slow material gains.

WHY IT WORKS

Pawn advances can attack without weakening their own king, and each side often has a clear target. The faster initiative can decide before material matters.

RECOGNITION CUES

Kings on different wings; centers closed or stable; rook pawns can advance with tempo.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

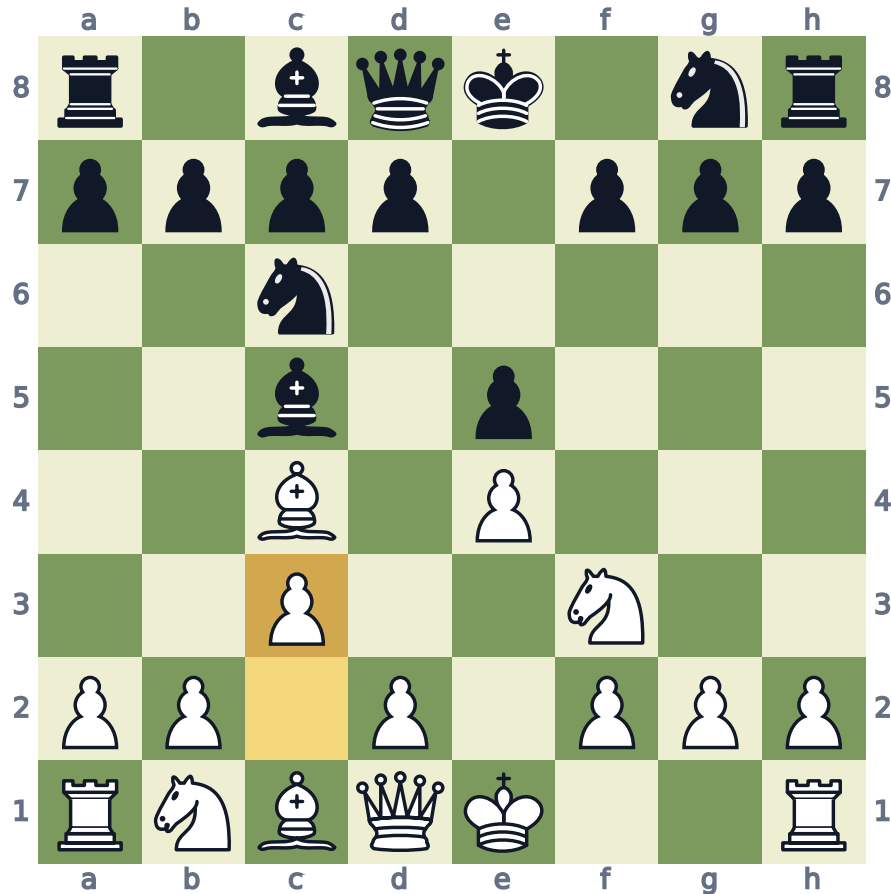
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

If the center can open against your king, central safety may be more urgent than racing on the wing.

BOARD LABORATORY 03

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



1... e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Opposite-Side Castling Makes Time Critical'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Pawn advances can attack without weakening their own king, and each side often has a clear target. The faster initiative can decide before material matters. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Replay ten opposite-castling games and mark every tempo spent on attack, defense, or unrelated material.

LEARNING UNIT 04

Exchange the Strongest Defender

THE RULE

Identify and remove the piece controlling entry squares, flight squares, or key blocks around the king.

WHY IT WORKS

King positions often depend on one defensive piece. Trading it changes tactical geometry and forces less suitable units into defense.

RECOGNITION CUES

Fianchetto bishop guards dark squares; knight covers mating square; queen holds the back rank.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

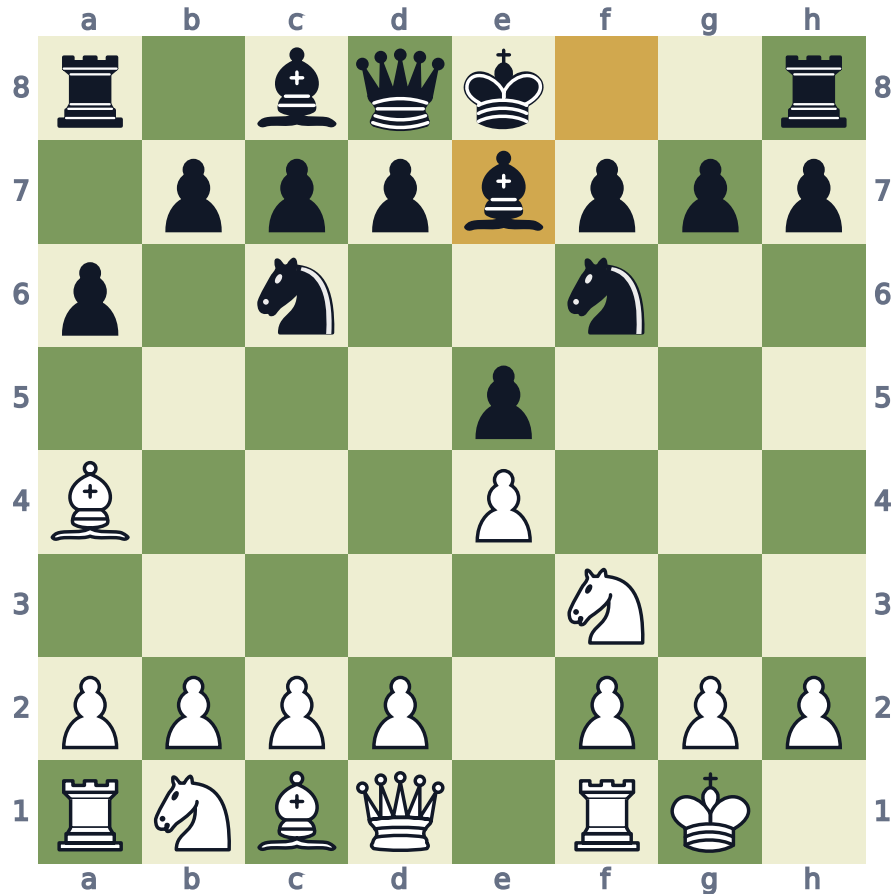
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

The exchange may remove your best attacker too. Verify that remaining pieces can use the weakened squares.

BOARD LABORATORY 04

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Exchange the Strongest Defender'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: King positions often depend on one defensive piece. Trading it changes tactical geometry and forces less suitable units into defense. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

In ten mating attacks, label the strongest defender and calculate one exchange or deflection method.

LEARNING UNIT 05

Fix a Weakness Before Attacking It

THE RULE

Prevent a target from advancing, exchanging, or escaping before piling up pressure.

WHY IT WORKS

A mobile weakness may disappear. Fixing it makes the attack stable and gives your pieces time to improve.

RECOGNITION CUES

Weak pawn can advance; target can be exchanged; a controlling pawn move can restrain it.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

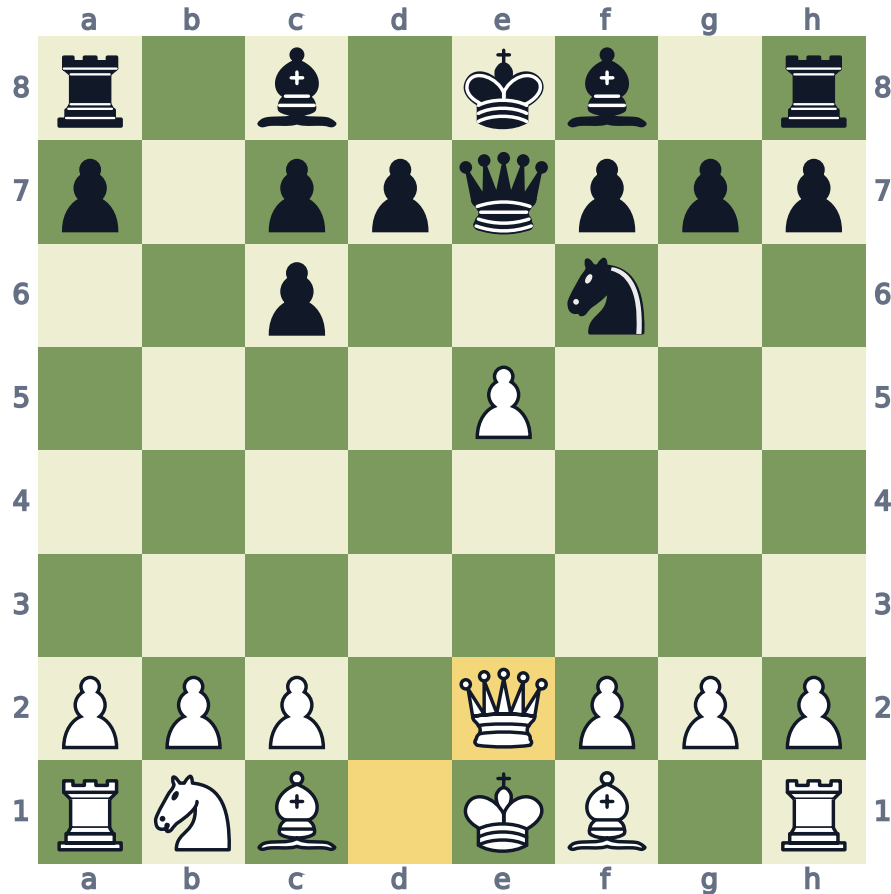
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
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- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Fixing can close lines your pieces need. Sometimes immediate tactical attack is stronger.

BOARD LABORATORY 05

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



4... Nf6 5. Nxc6 bxc6 6. e5 Qe7 7. Qe2

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Fix a Weakness Before Attacking It'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: A mobile weakness may disappear. Fixing it makes the attack stable and gives your pieces time to improve. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

For ten weak pawns, find a restraining move before adding another attacker.

LEARNING UNIT 06

Create a Second Weakness

THE RULE

When one target is fully defended, open play on the opposite wing or create another permanent problem.

WHY IT WORKS

A defender can hold one weakness by concentration. Two distant weaknesses stretch pieces beyond their ideal defensive squares.

RECOGNITION CUES

Opponent is tied to one pawn; direct breakthrough fails; you have space to switch wings.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

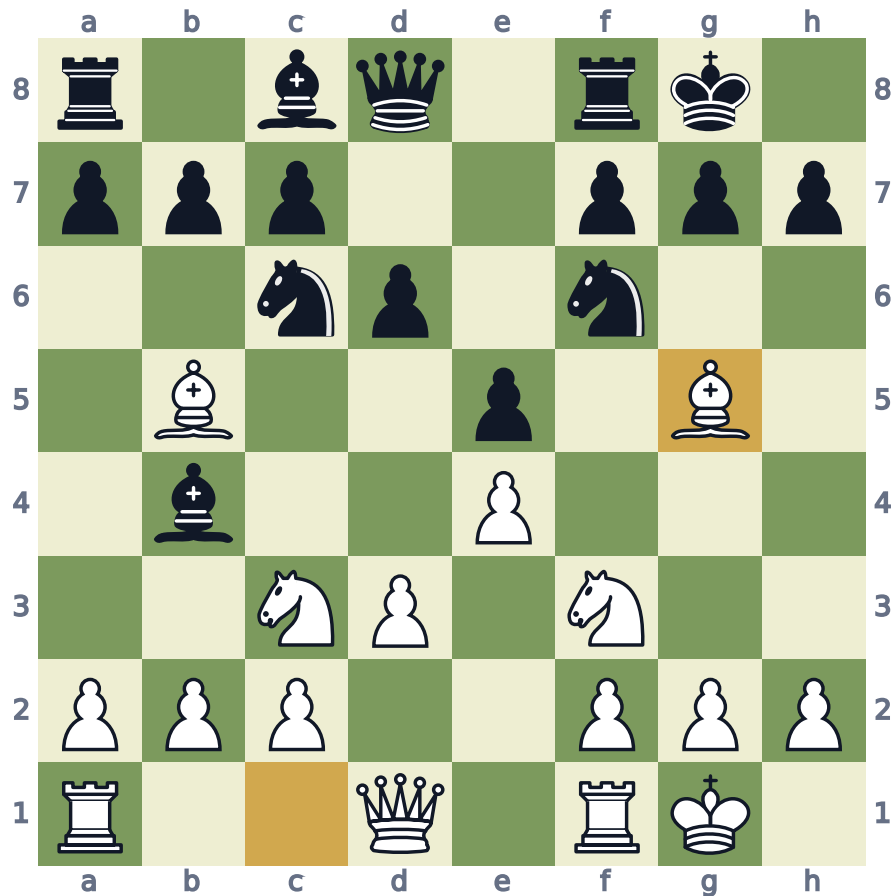
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Do not abandon a winning direct method to create unnecessary complications. The second weakness should be real and accessible.

BOARD LABORATORY 06

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



4... Bb4 5. O-O O-O 6. d3 d6 7. Bg5

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Create a Second Weakness'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: A defender can hold one weakness by concentration. Two distant weaknesses stretch pieces beyond their ideal defensive squares. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Study five technical wins and mark the moment the attacker switched from the first target to the second.

LEARNING UNIT 07

Launch a Pawn Storm Only With Central Security

THE RULE

Advance wing pawns when the center is closed, your king is elsewhere, or central counterplay is controlled.

WHY IT WORKS

Pawn storms gain space and open lines, but they consume tempi and leave squares. A stable center prevents the opponent from striking more efficiently.

RECOGNITION CUES

Opposite-side castling; locked center; pieces support the pawn advance.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.

BOUNDARY CONDITION

A tactical pawn push may be correct even in an open center, but it requires concrete calculation.

BOARD LABORATORY 07

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



1... e5 2. Nc3 Nf6 3. f4 d5 4. fxe5

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Launch a Pawn Storm Only With Central Security'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Pawn storms gain space and open lines, but they consume tempi and leave squares. A stable center prevents the opponent from striking more efficiently. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Before every pawn storm in five games, write the opponent's strongest central break and your answer.

LEARNING UNIT 08

Demand Concrete Compensation for a Sacrifice

THE RULE

Sacrifice material only for calculable gains such as mate, perpetual check, material recovery, lasting king exposure, or dominating activity.

WHY IT WORKS

Material is durable; initiative can fade. A sound sacrifice converts material into a form of advantage that persists long enough to matter.

RECOGNITION CUES

Forced lines; trapped king; development lead; several pieces can join quickly.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Not every sacrifice must be fully forced, but vague phrases like 'attack' are not enough when the initiative can be neutralized.

BOARD LABORATORY 08

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



4. h4 g4 5. Ne5 Nf6 6. Bc4 d5

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Demand Concrete Compensation for a Sacrifice'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Material is durable; initiative can fade. A sound sacrifice converts material into a form of advantage that persists long enough to matter. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

For ten sacrifices, classify compensation: forced, positional, insufficient, or unclear, and list the evidence.

LEARNING UNIT 09

Keep Queens When the King Is the Main Target

THE RULE

Avoid queen exchanges when your principal advantage is an attack and the enemy king remains vulnerable.

WHY IT WORKS

Queens create forcing checks and exploit open lines better than any piece. Trading them often converts king danger into a quieter structural game.

RECOGNITION CUES

Enemy king exposed; your queen is active; opponent offers a queen trade.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

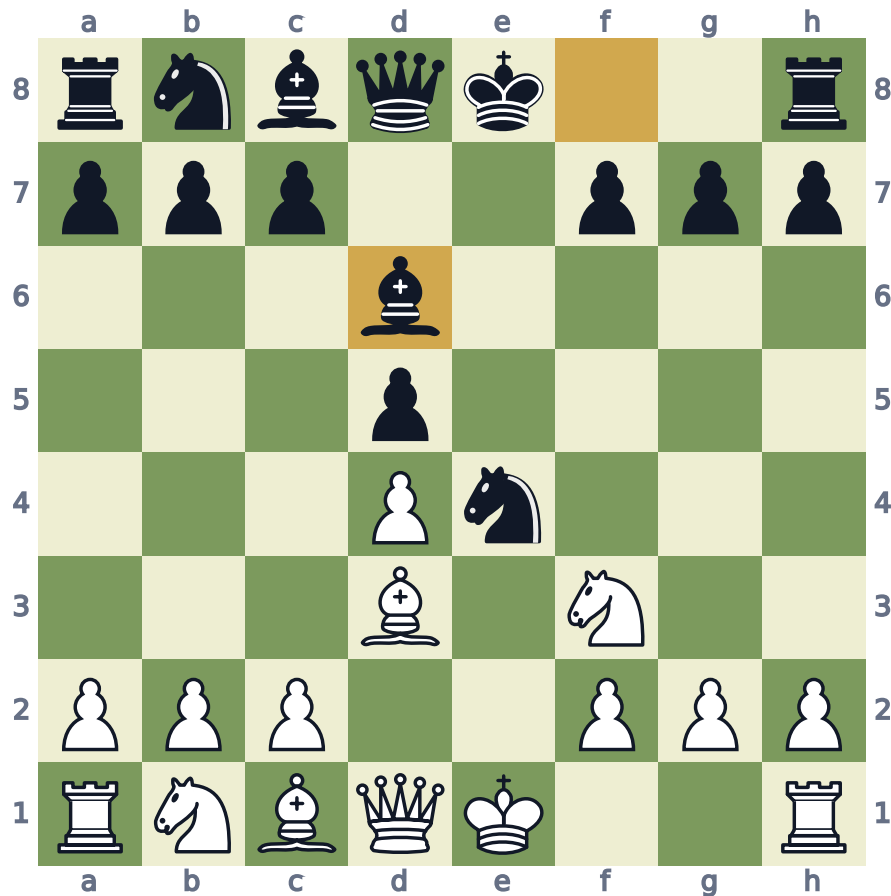
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
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- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Trade queens when it wins material, enters a winning endgame, or removes dangerous counterplay.

BOARD LABORATORY 09

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



4. Nf3 Nxe4 5. d4 d5 6. Bd3 Bd6

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Keep Queens When the King Is the Main Target'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Queens create forcing checks and exploit open lines better than any piece. Trading them often converts king danger into a quieter structural game. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

In ten attacking positions with a queen-trade offer, evaluate both the attack and the resulting endgame.

LEARNING UNIT 10

Use Threats to Gain Tempi

THE RULE

Choose improving moves that also create a real threat the opponent must answer.

WHY IT WORKS

A move with two functions advances your position while consuming the opponent's time. Repeated useful threats can build an initiative.

RECOGNITION CUES

Piece can develop with attack; pawn break gains tempo; queen or rook can enter with a concrete threat.

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Empty threats waste time if the opponent can ignore them or improve while defending.

BOARD LABORATORY 10

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



1... e5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 Nf6 4. Nc3

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Use Threats to Gain Tempi'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: A move with two functions advances your position while consuming the opponent's time. Repeated useful threats can build an initiative. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

For ten positions, find one move that improves your worst piece and creates a verifiable threat.

LEARNING UNIT 11

Challenge the Base of a Fianchetto

THE RULE

Attack the pawn and bishop complex supporting a fianchettoed king rather than sacrificing automatically on the shelter.

WHY IT WORKS

The fianchetto bishop guards key color squares. Exchanging it or undermining its pawns can create lasting entry squares for queen and minor pieces.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 11

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



1... d5 2. exd5 Qxd5 3. Nc3 Qd8 4. d4

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Challenge the Base of a Fianchetto'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: The fianchetto bishop guards key color squares. Exchanging it or undermining its pawns can create lasting entry squares for queen and minor pieces. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving challenge the base of a fianchetto. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 12

Exchange Sacrifices Need Positional Returns

THE RULE

Give a rook for a minor piece only when the resulting squares, pawns, king exposure, or domination provide durable compensation.

WHY IT WORKS

The nominal two-point loss can be offset by removing a crucial defender, destroying structure, or establishing pieces the opponent cannot challenge.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 12

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



4... Nfd7 5. f4 c5 6. Nf3 Nc6 7. Be3

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Exchange Sacrifices Need Positional Returns'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: The nominal two-point loss can be offset by removing a crucial defender, destroying structure, or establishing pieces the opponent cannot challenge. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving exchange sacrifices need positional returns. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 13

Use an Open Rook-Pawn File Against the King

THE RULE

Place a rook or queen on an opened h- or a-file when it leads directly to the castled king.

WHY IT WORKS

Pawn exchanges can create a straight attacking highway. Control of the entry square and the defender's rook-pawn geometry determine whether it is decisive.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 13

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



1... c6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bf5 4. Nf3

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Use an Open Rook-Pawn File Against the King'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Pawn exchanges can create a straight attacking highway. Control of the entry square and the defender's rook-pawn geometry determine whether it is decisive. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving use an open rook-pawn file against the king. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 14

Control Flight Squares Before Checking

THE RULE

Build a mating net by restricting the king's destinations before spending checks.

WHY IT WORKS

Checks without containment may help the king escape. Controlled flight squares convert ordinary checks into forcing progress and reduce defensive branches.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 14

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Nc6

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Control Flight Squares Before Checking'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Checks without containment may help the king escape. Controlled flight squares convert ordinary checks into forcing progress and reduce defensive branches. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving control flight squares before checking. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 15

Bring the Worst Attacker Into the Attack

THE RULE

Before forcing matters, improve the attacking piece contributing least.

WHY IT WORKS

An attack often stalls because one rook, bishop, or knight remains outside the king zone. Adding it increases threat density and reduces defensive freedom.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 15

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Bring the Worst Attacker Into the Attack'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: An attack often stalls because one rook, bishop, or knight remains outside the king zone. Adding it increases threat density and reduces defensive freedom. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving bring the worst attacker into the attack. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 16

Offer a Queen Trade to Break the Attack

THE RULE

When defending, use a queen exchange threat to force the attacker to lose time or abandon key squares.

WHY IT WORKS

Most mating attacks require queens. Even a declined exchange can displace the attacking queen and interrupt coordination.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 16

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



3... cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Offer a Queen Trade to Break the Attack'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Most mating attacks require queens. Even a declined exchange can displace the attacking queen and interrupt coordination. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving offer a queen trade to break the attack. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 17

Blockade the Pawn Storm

THE RULE

Stop attacking pawns on fixed squares before they can open files against your king.

WHY IT WORKS

A blocked pawn can become a shield for the defender and a target for pieces. Restraint buys time for central or opposite-wing counterplay.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

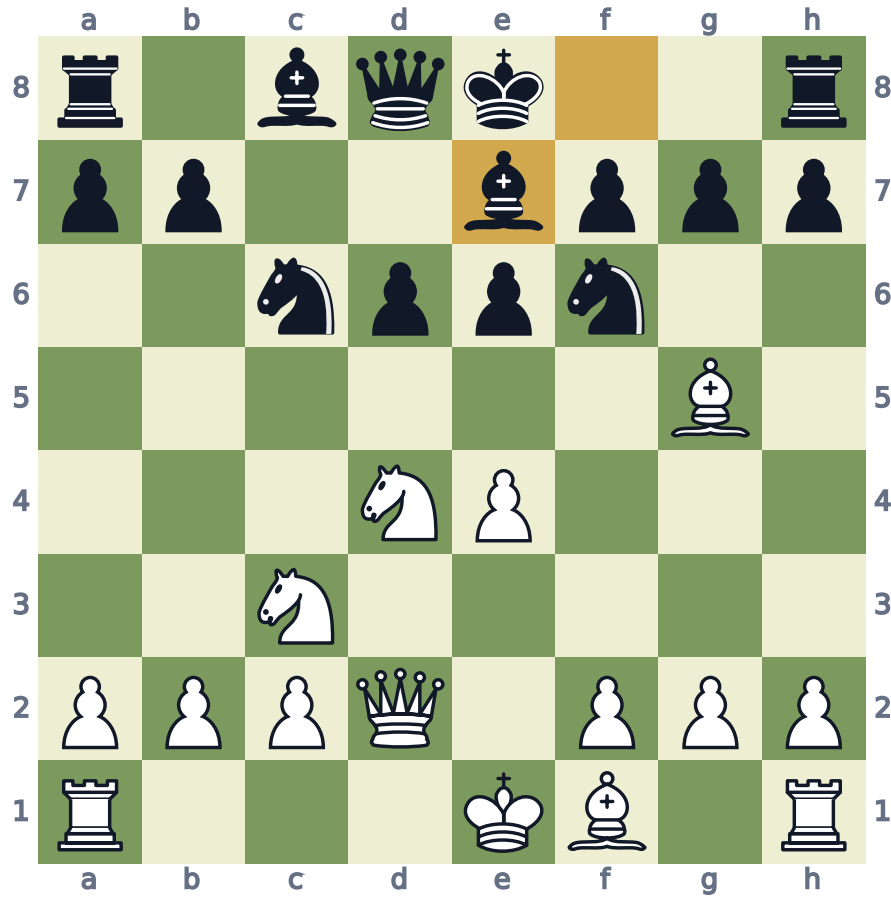
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 17

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



5. Nc3 Nc6 6. Bg5 e6 7. Qd2 Be7

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Blockade the Pawn Storm'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: A blocked pawn can become a shield for the defender and a target for pieces. Restraint buys time for central or opposite-wing counterplay. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving blockade the pawn storm. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 18

Counter-Sacrifice to Remove the Initiative

THE RULE

Return or invest material to open escape squares, trade attackers, or seize forcing counterplay.

WHY IT WORKS

A counter-sacrifice changes the move-order obligation. The attacker may be forced to defend or enter a simplified position where the original initiative disappears.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

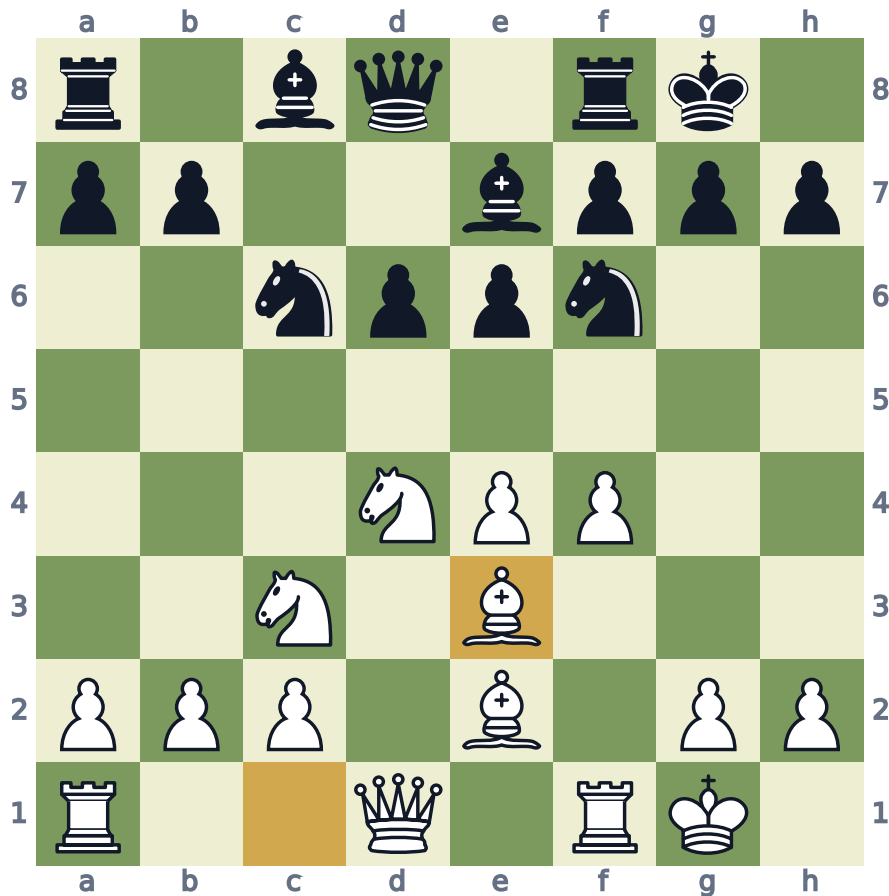
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 18

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



6... Be7 7. O-O O-O 8. f4 Nc6 9. Be3

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Counter-Sacrifice to Remove the Initiative'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: A counter-sacrifice changes the move-order obligation. The attacker may be forced to defend or enter a simplified position where the original initiative disappears. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving counter-sacrifice to remove the initiative. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 19

Perpetual Check Is an Active Defensive Resource

THE RULE

Search for repeated checking geometry when material defense is impossible.

WHY IT WORKS

A vulnerable opposing king can compensate for material loss. Repetition prevents conversion and forces the stronger side to address king safety.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

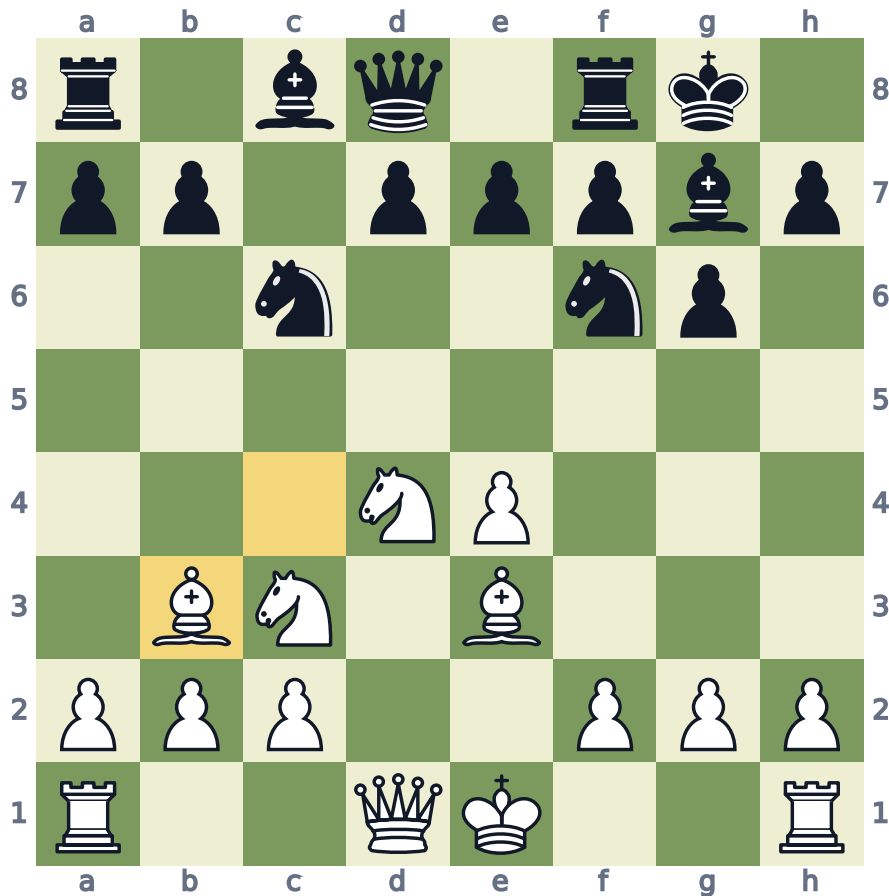
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 19

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



5... Bg7 6. Be3 Nf6 7. Bc4 O-O 8. Bb3

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Perpetual Check Is an Active Defensive Resource'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: A vulnerable opposing king can compensate for material loss. Repetition prevents conversion and forces the stronger side to address king safety. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving perpetual check is an active defensive resource. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 20

Defend the Entry Square, Not Every Attacked Pawn

THE RULE

Prioritize the invasion point that would make the opponent's pressure decisive.

WHY IT WORKS

Many pawn attacks are tolerable until a rook or queen penetrates. Controlling the entry square can make several apparent threats harmless.

RECOGNITION CUES

One king has reduced shelter; several pieces can enter the king zone; attack and counterplay are developing at different speeds

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

King attacks are concrete. Count effective attackers, defenders, forcing replies, and escape squares instead of trusting visual excitement.

BOARD LABORATORY 20

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nc6

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Defend the Entry Square, Not Every Attacked Pawn'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Many pawn attacks are tolerable until a rook or queen penetrates. Controlling the entry square can make several apparent threats harmless. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Analyze ten attacking or defensive positions involving defend the entry square, not every attacked pawn. Write the attacker's fastest line and the defender's most active resource.

LEARNING UNIT 21

Build the Mating Net Before Checking

THE RULE

Restrict the king's exits before spending the checks that drive it.

WHY IT WORKS

Checks without control can help a king escape. A mating net works by reducing legal squares until every check becomes more forcing and defensive interpositions no longer create an exit route.

RECOGNITION CUES

a king has limited squares; one piece performs two defensive jobs; a line could open with tempo; a forcing move changes the geometry

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

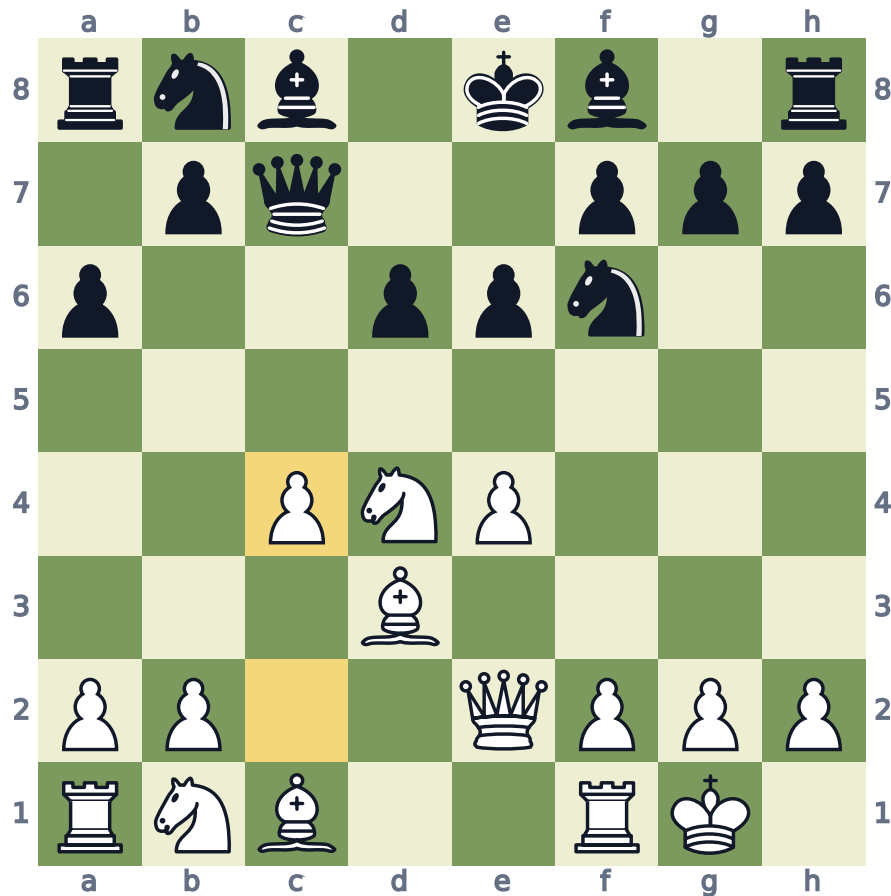
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.

BOUNDARY CONDITION

A familiar motif is only a search cue. Confirm the legal move order, the opponent's best defense, and the final material and king-safety balance before committing.

BOARD LABORATORY 21

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



5... Qc7 6. O-O Nf6 7. Qe2 d6 8. c4

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Build the Mating Net Before Checking'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Checks without control can help a king escape. A mating net works by reducing legal squares until every check becomes more forcing and defensive interpositions no longer create an exit route. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Collect twelve positions connected to 'Build the Mating Net Before Checking'. For each, write three candidates, the opponent's strongest reply, and a one-sentence evaluation. Revisit the same positions without notes after three and seven...

LEARNING UNIT 22

Open Lines with a Pawn Sacrifice

THE RULE

Value a pawn sacrifice by the files, diagonals, and tempi it opens against the king.

WHY IT WORKS

Pawns often seal the exact routes heavy pieces need. Removing one with tempo can activate several pieces simultaneously, so the compensation comes from coordinated access rather than the pawn's nominal value.

RECOGNITION CUES

a king has limited squares; one piece performs two defensive jobs; a line could open with tempo; a forcing move changes the geometry

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

A familiar motif is only a search cue. Confirm the legal move order, the opponent's best defense, and the final material and king-safety balance before committing.

BOARD LABORATORY 22

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



5. Nc3 e5 6. Ndb5 d6 7. Bg5 a6

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Open Lines with a Pawn Sacrifice'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Pawns often seal the exact routes heavy pieces need. Removing one with tempo can activate several pieces simultaneously, so the compensation comes from coordinated access rather than the pawn's nominal value. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Collect twelve positions connected to 'Open Lines with a Pawn Sacrifice'. For each, write three candidates, the opponent's strongest reply, and a one-sentence evaluation. Revisit the same positions without notes after three and seven days; scor...

LEARNING UNIT 23

Refute Your Own Sacrifice

THE RULE

Before sacrificing, actively search for the defender's least cooperative response.

WHY IT WORKS

Attackers naturally calculate attractive replies that confirm the idea. Looking for declined sacrifices, queen trades, counterchecks, and cold defensive retreats counters that bias and reveals whether the compensation is forced or merely hoped for.

RECOGNITION CUES

the position has several plausible forcing continuations; one branch depends on a long visualization; the opponent has an active tactical reply

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

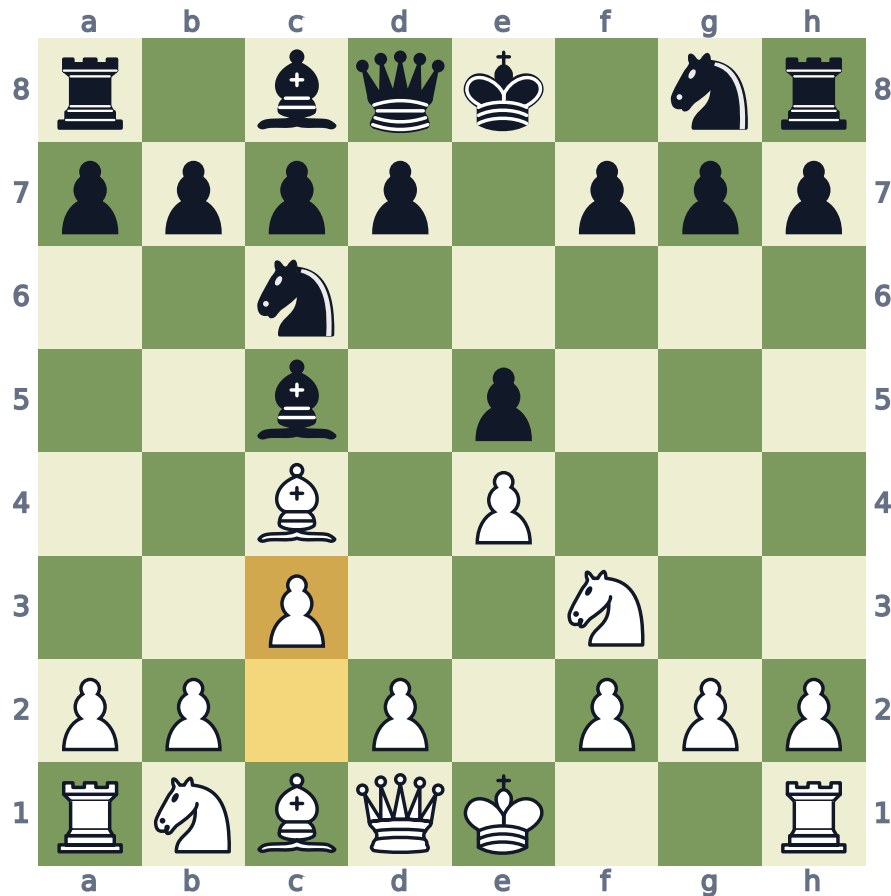
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Do not calculate mechanically to a fixed depth. Stop a branch when the position is forced, clearly evaluated, or superseded by a stronger candidate, but never before checking the opponent's forcing replies.

BOARD LABORATORY 23

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



1... e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Bc5 4. c3

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Refute Your Own Sacrifice'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Attackers naturally calculate attractive replies that confirm the idea. Looking for declined sacrifices, queen trades, counterchecks, and cold defensive retreats counters that bias and reveals whether the compensation is forced or merely hoped for. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Collect twelve positions connected to 'Refute Your Own Sacrifice'. For each, write three candidates, the opponent's strongest reply, and a one-sentence evaluation. Revisit the same positions without notes after three and seven days; scor...

LEARNING UNIT 24

Search for Quiet Tactical Moves

THE RULE

After checking forcing moves, look for a quiet move that creates two threats or removes the only defense.

WHY IT WORKS

Some combinations are forced by restriction rather than check. A quiet move can dominate escape squares, unpin an attacker, or add a second threat, leaving the defender without a move that answers everything.

RECOGNITION CUES

the position has several plausible forcing continuations; one branch depends on a long visualization; the opponent has an active tactical reply

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

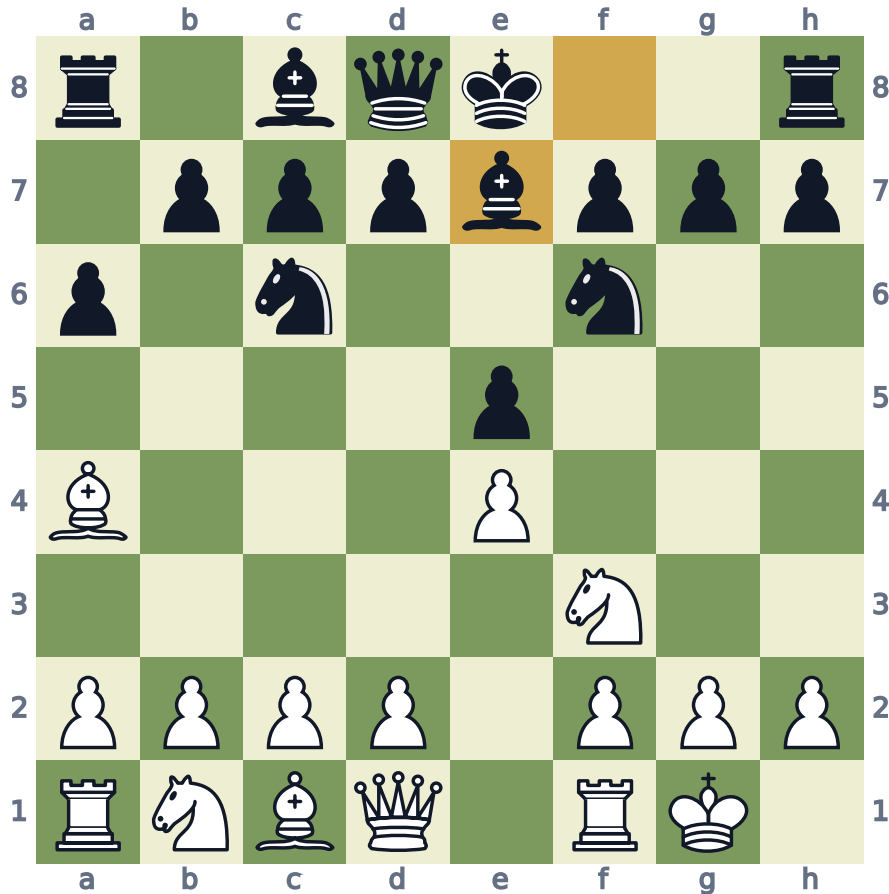
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Do not calculate mechanically to a fixed depth. Stop a branch when the position is forced, clearly evaluated, or superseded by a stronger candidate, but never before checking the opponent's forcing replies.

BOARD LABORATORY 24

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O Be7

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Search for Quiet Tactical Moves'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: Some combinations are forced by restriction rather than check. A quiet move can dominate escape squares, unpin an attacker, or add a second threat, leaving the defender without a move that answers everything. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Collect twelve positions connected to 'Search for Quiet Tactical Moves'. For each, write three candidates, the opponent's strongest reply, and a one-sentence evaluation. Revisit the same positions without notes after three and seven days; scor...

LEARNING UNIT 25

Align a Battery with a Future Target

THE RULE

Build queen-bishop or doubled-rook batteries on lines that can be opened with tempo.

WHY IT WORKS

A battery concentrates multiple attackers along one geometric channel. Its real power appears when a pawn break or clearance move opens that channel faster than the defender can add protection.

RECOGNITION CUES

a king has limited squares; one piece performs two defensive jobs; a line could open with tempo; a forcing move changes the geometry

APPLY IT OVER THE BOARD

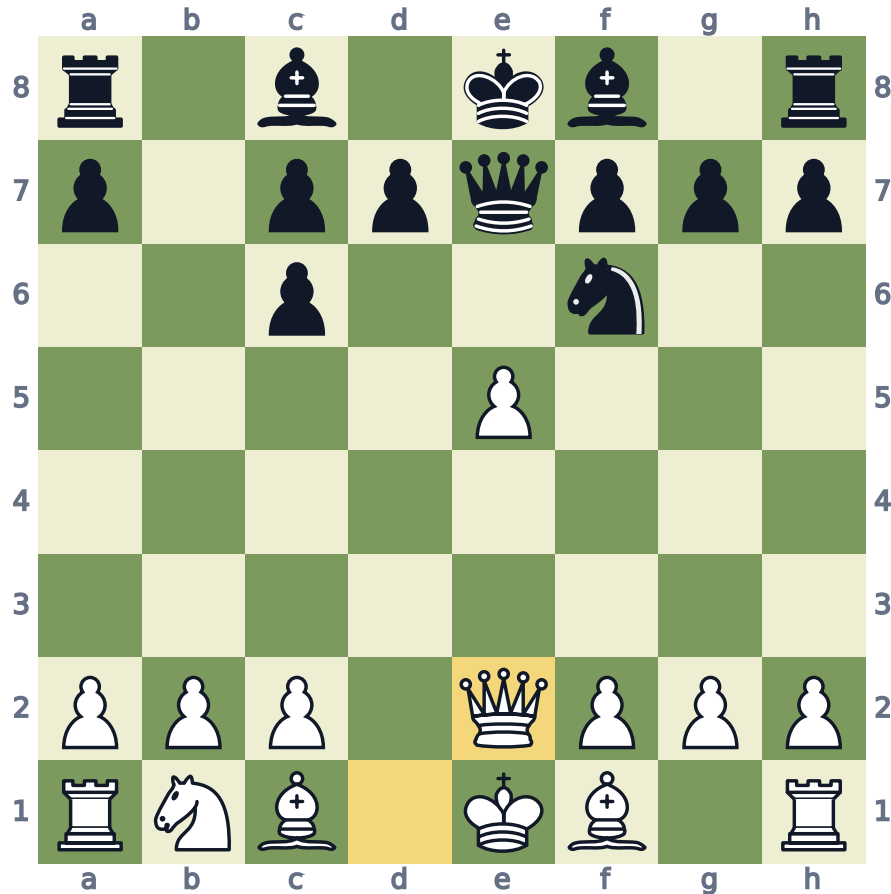
- Count effective attackers and defenders.
- Map entry routes and escape squares.
- Find the defender holding the position together.
- Compare forcing moves with a quiet restriction move.
- Verify the attack against checks, queen trades, and declined sacrifices.
-

BOUNDARY CONDITION

A familiar motif is only a search cue. Confirm the legal move order, the opponent's best defense, and the final material and king-safety balance before committing.

BOARD LABORATORY 25

Use the idea, then try to disprove it



4... Nf6 5. Nxc6 bxc6 6. e5 Qe7 7. Qe2

YOUR TASK

Without moving the pieces, apply 'Align a Battery with a Future Target'. List two or three candidates, the opponent's strongest forcing reply, and the feature that makes the principle relevant or irrelevant here.

MODEL ANSWER STANDARD

A strong answer does more than name the rule. It explains the mechanism: A battery concentrates multiple attackers along one geometric channel. Its real power appears when a pawn break or clearance move opens that channel faster than the defender can add protection. Then it verifies the best opposing reply and evaluates the resulting material, king safety, activity, structure, and initiative.

TRAINING TRANSFER

Collect twelve positions connected to 'Align a Battery with a Future Target'. For each, write three candidates, the opponent's strongest reply, and a one-sentence evaluation. Revisit the same positions without notes after three and seven days.

RETRIEVAL TEST

Can you explain the course without looking?

1

State the five-step decision protocol from memory.

2

Name three recognition cues that should make you slow down.

3

Choose five learning units and explain the causal mechanism behind each rule.

4

For each chosen rule, give one position where it should not be applied mechanically.

5

Describe the opponent's strongest practical resource in your most recent serious game.

6

Name one recurring error and the exact training drill that addresses its cause.

SCORING

2 points: accurate rule plus mechanism. 1 point: useful but incomplete. 0 points: slogan only. Restudy any item below 2 and retrieve it again tomorrow.

TRAINING PLAN

Four weeks to make the ideas usable

WEEK 1 - UNDERSTAND

Study the first quarter of the course. After every lesson, explain why the rule works and when it fails.

WEEK 2 - RECOGNIZE

Study the second quarter. Mix old and new diagrams so the name of the motif is not given in advance.

WEEK 3 - CALCULATE

Finish the course. Use a clock and write candidates, best defense, and endpoint evaluation.

WEEK 4 - TRANSFER

Play two slow games. Mark every moment when the course's protocol changed your decision, then analyze unaided.

LONG-TERM REVIEW

Return after 7, 14, and 30 days. Do not reread first. Attempt the retrieval test, review only missed items, and find one example from your own games.

REFERENCE

How this course fits the library

COURSE ROLE

Learn when an attack is justified, how to bring pieces into the king zone, how to remove defenders, and when to convert pressure into a safer gain.

LIBRARY PRINCIPLE

Strong chess comes from a loop: notice the right features, generate serious candidates, calculate the opponent's best resistance, evaluate the destination position, and learn from the decision process.

ABOUT THE DIAGRAMS

Boards use Cburnett-style vector chess pieces with solid dark pieces and high-contrast olive and cream squares. Piece artwork is credited to Colin M. L. Burnett and the Lichess Cburnett set under GPLv2+.

EDITION NOTES

First edition, September 2026. 25 learning units. Explanations and exercises are designed for personal study and should be tested against actual games and concrete calculation.

THE FINAL QUESTION

What will you do differently on your very next move? If the course has not changed a behavior, choose one rule, attach it to a visible board cue, and practice it in five slow games.